

‘Criticism has always been a source of motivation for me’

It’s just day five since he was crowned 2024 FIDE World Chess champion (which he celebrated with a bungee jump), and **Gukesh Dommaraju** is still learning to adjust to the fanfare. In an exclusive interview with **Deputy Editor Suhani Singh**, Guki, as he is fondly referred to by fans, talks about his love for chess, the impact of ‘Vishy Sir’, his Gen Z compatriots, the streaming mania around chess and future goals. Excerpts:

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**